

The Noble Perfection of Wisdom: A Verse Condensation

Āryaprajñāpāramitāsamcayagāthā · Toh 13 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་ཤེས་རབ་ཀྱི་ཕྱོད་ལྷན་པ་སྣུ་པ་ཆགས་སྤྱུང་པ།

Toh 13 in the Kangyur is the Āryaprajñāpāramitāsamcayagāthā, known in Tibetan as the Phags pa shes rab kyi pha rol tu phyin pa sdud pa tshigs su bcad pa, and rendered in English as The Noble Perfection of Wisdom: A Verse Condensation. It belongs to the Perfection of Wisdom class of sūtras, one of the most important groupings in the Kangyur, and presents the profound teachings on prajñāpāramitā — the wisdom gone beyond — in metrical verse form rather than the extended prose dialogues characteristic of longer works in this cycle. As its title indicates, the text functions as a poetic summary or condensation of the Perfection of Wisdom teachings, covering themes such as omniscience, the nature of emptiness, and the path of the bodhisattva. It is among the earliest and most studied verse formulations of prajñāpāramitā doctrine and has been widely used across Buddhist traditions as a concise yet comprehensive expression of these teachings.

In the language of India: Āryaprajñāpāramitāsamcayagāthā. In the language of Tibet: The Noble Perfection of Wisdom in Verse — a Condensation. Homage to the noble Mañjuśrī.

Then again the Blessed One (the Buddha), in order to bring perfect joy to those four assemblies, taught this Perfection of Wisdom and at that time spoke these verses:

Establish supreme joy, reverence, and faith close at hand.
Having dispelled the obscurations and afflictions, transcend all defilement.
The wisdom gone beyond, satisfied by penetrative understanding of the benefit of beings —
that in which the courageous ones engage: hear this now.

The first section: teaching omniscience.

However many rivers flow down upon this Jambudvīpa,
producing flowers, fruits, medicines, and forests —
the lord of nāgas (Skt. nāga), the nāga-king, dwelling in the cool lake, is their support:
that is the power and splendor of that lord of nāgas.

However much the śrāvakas (Skt. śrāvaka) of the Victor teach the Dharma,
however much they set forth reasoned exposition and explanation,
however much they bring about supreme noble happiness and its fruit is
attained —
all of that too is the power of the Tathāgata.

Why is this? Because whatever manner of Dharma the Victor taught,
the foremost of humans, having become a disciple, trained in it with
earnestness,
and having directly realized it, teaches the training just as it is.
It is done through the power of the buddha, not through one's own personal
strength.

One in whom the supreme Perfection of Wisdom is without object,
in whom the bodhisattva is without object, and the awakening mind
(bodhicitta) without object —
one who upon hearing this is neither confused nor afraid:
that bodhisattva practices the wisdom of the Sugata (the well-gone one, a
buddha).

There is no form, no sensation, no perception, no mentation.
In that, there is not even a particle of consciousness that abides.
It does not abide in any phenomenon; it practices without abiding.
Without anything to be grasped, one attains the awakening of the Sugatas.

Just as a skilled wandering magician, knowing the illusion,
produces the apparent destruction of the aggregates without an object —
so too a bodhisattva who knows phenomena in this way
does not touch nirvāṇa, yet abides in wisdom.

Further: what is this wisdom, whose is it?
Contemplating that all these phenomena are empty, from what does it come?
Having examined closely, without shrinking or fear —
that bodhisattva is close to awakening.

If one, while lacking understanding, forms the notion of form,
and while engaging in the aggregates of sensation, mentation, and
consciousness,
one thinks "these aggregates are empty" — yet that bodhisattva
practices with signs and does not have faith in the unborn ground.

But one who is neither form nor sensation, not perception nor mentation, who does not engage in consciousness, who practices without abiding — that one, seeing that there is no object called "practice," relies on wisdom, and touches the supreme peaceful samādhi (meditative absorption) of the unborn.

Whatever bodhisattva thus abides here, at peace in themselves — that one has been prophesied by the Tathāgatas of the past.

There is no pride in thinking "I am in equipoise" or "I have arisen" — why? Because the intrinsic nature of phenomena is fully known.

If one practices in this way, one practices the wisdom of the Sugatas, for one fully knows that this practice without practicing is itself the practice. Whatever phenomenon one practices, it does not become an object — this is practicing the supreme Perfection of Wisdom.

Whatever does not exist is called "nonexistent."

The childish examine that and make it either existent or nonexistent.

These two — existence and nonexistence — are a phenomenon free of both.

Whatever bodhisattva knows this will certainly emerge.

One who knows that the five aggregates here are like a magical illusion, and does not make the magical illusion one thing and the aggregates another —

free of manifold perceptions and dwelling in nearness to peace — this is practicing the supreme Perfection of Wisdom.

One who has a spiritual friend and has gained insight will not come to be frightened upon hearing the Mother of the Victors.

But one who has evil companions and relies upon others is like a raw vessel struck by water — it breaks apart.

Why is this one called a bodhisattva?

Because one wishes to sever attachment and to exhaust attachment in all things,

and to touch the Victors' awakening, which is free of attachment.

For this reason, one obtains the name "bodhisattva."

Why is this one called a great being (mahāsattva)?

Because one is supreme among the many multitudes of sentient beings, and cuts through the great views of the realm of sentient beings.

Therefore one is rightly called a "great being."

Because of great giving, great intelligence, and great power,
because of entering the supreme Great Vehicle of the Victors,
because of donning the great armor and subduing the illusions of Māra —
for these reasons one is rightly called a "great being."

For example, when a magician conjures at a crossroads
and sets about cutting off the heads of a great multitude of people —
those who are killed are of such a nature; likewise the awakening mind
of one who truly knows that all beings are like emanations holds no fear.

Form, perception, feeling, mental formations,
and consciousness are neither bound nor liberated — they do not exist as
such.

Thus, to enter into awakening with a mind free of timidity —
this is the supreme armor of noble persons.

Why is this called the Great Vehicle of awakening?
Because riding upon it, one soothes all sentient beings' sorrow.
This vehicle is like the sky — a vast and measureless palace —
the supreme vehicle by which joy and happiness are fully obtained.

One who rides upon it apprehends no direction in which one goes;
one does not apprehend the going that is said to be going to nirvāṇa.
Just as a person who has died has no movement —
for that reason, that is rightly called "nirvāṇa."

The bodhisattva apprehends neither the earlier limit nor the later limit,
nor anything arisen in the present — the three times are purified.
Those things are unconditioned and free of conceptual elaboration.
This is practicing the supreme Perfection of Wisdom.

When the time comes that a bodhisattva is learned and perceptive,
one contemplates non-arising and acts accordingly,
and though one arouses great compassion, one holds no perception of
sentient beings —
this is practicing the supreme Perfection of Wisdom.

If one arouses a perception of sentient beings and a perception of suffering,
thinking "I shall act for the benefit of beings and abandon suffering,"
and construes self and sentient beings as truly existent — that is a
bodhisattva, indeed,
but this is not practicing the supreme Perfection of Wisdom.

One knows all sentient beings to be just as one knows oneself to be;
one knows all phenomena to be just as one knows all sentient beings to be;
and one does not conceive of either non-arising or arising —
this is practicing the supreme Perfection of Wisdom.

However many names of Dharma are spoken throughout all the worlds —
having transcended arising and truly gone beyond them all —
one attains the noble, deathless gnosis that is other than none of these.
Therefore this is called the Perfection of Wisdom.

Whatever bodhisattva practices thus without doubt,
possessing wisdom and knowing how to abide in evenness —
having fully understood that phenomena have no intrinsic nature —
this is practicing the supreme Perfection of Wisdom.

The second section teaches knowledge of all paths.

One who does not abide in form, does not abide in feeling,
one who does not abide in perception, does not abide in mental formations,
one who does not abide in consciousness — abides in the nature of reality.
This is practicing the supreme Perfection of Wisdom.

Permanence and impermanence, pleasure and suffering, pleasant and unpleasant,
self and selflessness, suchness and the emptiness of suchness,
the attainment of fruits and the grounds of the arhat — without abiding in these —

the grounds of the pratyekabuddha, and likewise the grounds of the buddhas
— without abiding in these.

Just as the guide does not abide in the unconditioned element,
so too without abiding in the conditioned, one moves without a home.
Thus the bodhisattva abides in groundlessness as a ground.
This groundless ground is what the Victors have declared as the abode.

Those who wish to become hearers of the Sugata (the well-gone Buddha),
pratyekabuddhas, and likewise sovereigns of the Dharma —
without relying upon this patience, they cannot attain these things.
It is like one who cannot see the near shore or the far shore when crossing over.

The teaching of the Dharma and the hearing of it, and whatever is to be explained,

the attainment of fruits, the condition-awakened ones, and likewise the Protector of the World —
the nirvāṇa attained by the learned and the clear-minded —
all of this the Tathāgata has taught to be like an illusion.

Of these four kinds of persons, none is frightened by this:
the son of the Victors who is skilled in truth and who is irreversible,
the arhat who has cleared away defilements and abandoned doubt,
and the fourth — the one fully held by a virtuous spiritual friend.

A bodhisattva skilled in knowledge who practices in this way
does not learn from the level of the arhat, nor from the level of
condition-awakening.

For the sake of omniscience alone, one learns from the Dharma of the
buddhas.

One who learns in the mode of neither learning nor not-learning — that is true
learning.

Not for the sake of increasing or diminishing form, or grasping it,
not learning in order to grasp the many diverse phenomena —
yet one learns, and even omniscience itself is encompassed in that grasping.
Whatever renunciation there is — this is learning that delights in virtue.

Form is not wisdom, and in form there is no wisdom.

Consciousness, perception, feeling, and volition —
these are not wisdom, and in them too there is no wisdom.

This is like the element of space — undifferentiated, without distinction.

The intrinsic nature of all referential objects is without a further extreme.

The intrinsic nature of sentient beings is also without a further extreme.

The intrinsic nature of the element of space is also without a further extreme.

The wisdom that knows the world is also without a further extreme.

The guide has fully proclaimed that perception belongs to the near shore.

Through shattering perception and relinquishing it, one goes to the far shore.

Those who attain freedom from perception — they have attained the
subsequent.

Having gone to the far shore, they abide in the word of the Teacher.

Even if the Teacher were to remain for as many aeons as there are grains of
sand in the Ganges

and proclaim the sound "sentient being" throughout all that time —
since beings are primordially pure, how could they ever come to be born?
This is practicing the supreme Perfection of Wisdom.

When I speak in accord with this supreme Perfection of Wisdom,
at that moment the supreme being of former times declared:
"In a future time you shall become a buddha" —
thus did the Victor speak, saying that I received this prophecy.

Whoever takes this Perfection of Wisdom as a protector, enacts it,
and with reverence upholds and comprehends it —
poison, weapons, fire, and water cannot harm that one,
and māra and māra's cohorts will find no opportunity.

Some make stūpas of the seven precious substances for the Sugata who has
fully passed into nirvāṇa,
and worship them — stūpas of the Sugata filling worlds
as numerous as ten million times the grains of sand in the Ganges,
fully adorning and grasping those worlds, boundless beyond count —
and all the sentient beings dwelling therein, as many as there may be,
doing nothing else but making offerings with divine flowers, supreme incense,
and perfumed ointments, worshipping for three times an aeon or even more
than that.

But whoever, from this source from which the ten powers of the supreme
guide arise —
this mother of the Sugata — writes it in a book
and upholds it, and with flowers and ointments makes homage —
the merit of building stūpas and making offerings cannot compare with that.

This Perfection of Wisdom of the Victors is a great knowledge-mantra:
it pacifies the Dharma of suffering and sorrow for the many classes of sentient
beings.

Those who have passed beyond, and those who are the guardians of the world
in all ten directions —
they trained in this knowledge-mantra and became the unsurpassed king of
healers.

Those who act with benefit and compassion for beings —
training in this knowledge-mantra, the wise touch awakening.

Know that all happiness, whether conditioned or unconditioned,
arises from this very source.

As a seed planted in the ground gives rise to what grows from it,
and gathering together, many forms come into being —

so the five perfections, and whatever qualities of awakening there may be,
all of them arise from the Perfection of Wisdom.

The road along which the wheel-turning king always travels
is that very road on which all seven precious things and all his armies move.
Likewise, the path from which the Victor's Perfection of Wisdom proceeds
is the path from which all virtuous qualities and phenomena proceed.

The Victor, having answered fully all the questions of Śakra (Indra, the king of
the gods), replied:

"Even if all the buddha-fields equal in number to the grains of sand of the
Ganges

were filled with the relics of the Victors, piled up in heaps —
still I would take up this very Perfection of Wisdom.

Why? Not because I am disrespectful toward the bodily relics,
but I honor them through complete cultivation of wisdom.

Just as a king obtains offerings and reverence when a support is present,
so the relics of the Buddhas depend upon the Perfection of Wisdom.

A precious jewel endowed with every quality, of priceless worth —
wherever a treasure is bestowed, that place is worthy of veneration.

Even when the jewel has been removed, one still rejoices in the
treasure-casket,

for those qualities belonged to that precious jewel.

In the same way, through the supreme qualities of the Perfection of Wisdom,
even after the Victors have passed into nirvāṇa, their relics receive homage.

Therefore, whoever wishes to uphold the qualities of the Victors
should take up this Perfection of Wisdom — this is liberation.

Wisdom is that which precedes the giving of gifts;

and so it is with moral discipline, patience, diligence, and meditative
concentration.

It retains virtuous qualities so that they are not wasted.

This reveals all phenomena under a single principle.

Consider, for example, the thousands of millions of trees in Jambudvīpa, with their many varied forms and their multitude of shapes — apart from their shadows being enumerated in number, the shadows themselves are neither many nor separately distinct.

In the same way, these five perfections of the Victors all come to bear the very name of the Perfection of Wisdom. When all is fully dedicated for the sake of omniscience, these six all become of one flavor, called awakening.

If a bodhisattva, while not yet fully understanding, takes to teaching the impermanence of form, perception, feeling, mental formations, and consciousness, and acts upon what is compounded — the wise never bring about the destruction of phenomena.

One who does not apprehend form, does not apprehend feeling, does not perceive perception, who does not apprehend consciousness, and does not perceive mental formations, who thoroughly understands all phenomena as unborn and empty — this is the conduct of the supreme Perfection of Wisdom.

As for one who leads all the sentient beings dwelling in fields equal in number to the grains of sand of the Ganges to the state of arhathood — whoever writes out this Perfection of Wisdom and gives the book to the most excellent of sentient beings, their merit is far superior.

Why? Because those supreme in speech, having trained in this, teach all phenomena here as emptiness.

Hearing that, a śrāvaka swiftly touches liberation; one touches the awakening of a pratyekabuddha, and one touches the awakening of a buddha.

If a world tree were to arise without a sprout, it would not come to be; and where would its branches, flowers, and fruit come from?

If buddhas were to arise in the world without bodhicitta, it would not come to be;

how then could Śakra, Brahmā, and the śrāvakas with their hundredfold fruits arise?

When the orb of the sun spreads its web of light,
the beings who engage in activity do so likewise.

When, for the sake of the wise, bodhicitta arises in the world —

sentient beings are endowed with the qualities and phenomena of wisdom. Consider: if the lord of nāgas were absent from the unheated lake, how could rivers flow down into this land of Jambudvīpa? Without rivers, flowers and fruit could not arise, and the ocean too would be without its multitude of precious forms. In just the same way, if bodhicitta is absent, how could the gnosis of the Sugata arise throughout all these worlds? Without gnosis, qualities cannot increase, there is no awakening, and the Dharma of the buddhas — vast as the ocean — would likewise cease to exist.

In this world, all the living creatures that give light pour forth their rays so that illumination may reach everyone, yet a single ray from the orb of the sun is supremely excellent, and all those gathered rays of the light-givers together cannot match it. However great the accumulations of merit that the gathered assemblies of śrāvakas produce through generosity, moral discipline, meditation, and all they are richly endowed with — a single thought of rejoicing in a bodhisattva's wake surpasses the entire mass of merit belonging to the śrāvaka assembly.

Of all the buddhas of the past — inconceivable hundreds of millions of them — dwelling in the immeasurable billions of countless buddha-fields, and of all those protectors of the world who have already passed into nirvāṇa and who teach the precious Dharma so that suffering may be exhausted: from the first moment they aroused the supreme resolve for awakening to the final hour when the Dharma of those great guides comes to an end — whatever merit belongs to those Victors, the Dharma of the buddhas together with the perfections, whatever virtue belongs to the children of the buddhas, the śrāvakas, those in training and those beyond training, defiled virtue and undefiled — gathering all of this together and rejoicing in the bodhisattvas, one dedicates it all to awakening for the sake and benefit of beings.

If at the moment of total dedication a perception of dedicating should arise in the mind, and if the perception is of awakening, of dedicating, and of sentient beings, then because of that perception the mind clings to three objects — the viewed position, the abiding, and the mind itself — and because there is something apprehended, the dedication does not become complete.

But if one understands that this phenomenon ceases and is exhausted, that to wherever one dedicates is likewise exhausted, that phenomenon never dedicates to phenomenon — if one comes to know this clearly, then the dedication is truly complete.

If one makes a sign of it, that is not dedication. If there is no sign, then it is a dedication to awakening. Just as fine food mixed with poison becomes harmful, the Victors have declared that dwelling on virtuous phenomena is like that as well. Therefore the training in dedicating in this way is as follows: rejoice in the manner in which those Victors know that virtue — whatever its aspect, whatever its arising, whatever its defining mark — and dedicate in just that way.

When one thus dedicates merit to awakening, the Victors have declared: speak of the buddha who is without defilement and does not perish. The bodhisattva who thus dedicates with heroism while remaining object-referenced regarding the world surpasses and overwhelms every bodhisattva who is object-referenced.

Blind people without a guide, though they number in the hundreds of millions, do not know the road and cannot enter a city. Without wisdom, these five perfections are like the blind — without a guide they cannot touch awakening. But when one is fully held by wisdom, one has found the eye and receives this very name. Just as a painted work that is otherwise complete but lacks eyes — as long as the eye has not been painted in, the reward is not obtained — so too when wisdom thoroughly dissolves conditioned and unconditioned phenomena, white and dark alike, and does not apprehend even a particle, then in the world the counting of the Perfection of Wisdom proceeds — like the sky, resting nowhere at all.

If I am to practice the wisdom of the Victors
and liberate from contact with suffering the many hundreds of millions of
sentient beings —

one who perceives sentient beings as real is a bodhisattva in name only — this is not the practice of the supreme Perfection of Wisdom. Whatever bodhisattva practiced in former times, when practicing this Perfection there is no doubt that he is skilled. As soon as he hears it, he gives rise to the perception of the Teacher; through that, he swiftly comes to realize the peace of awakening. Even if in former times of practice one honored hundreds of millions of buddhas, if one has no faith in the Perfection of Wisdom of the Victors, then

upon hearing it that faint-hearted one rejects it; having rejected it and become without refuge, he goes to the Avīci hell. Therefore, if one wishes to touch the supreme gnosis of a buddha, have faith in this, the Mother of the Victors. For example, it would be wrong to be like a merchant who has gone to the isle of jewels and returns empty-handed. Know that the purity of form is the purity of the fruit; when the fruit and form are pure, omniscience itself becomes pure. Omniscience, the pure fruit, and the purity of form are like the element of space — indivisible, without partition.

The third section teaches the knowledge of all foundations. The hero who practices the Perfection of Wisdom: he is not liberated by passing wholly beyond the three realms, yet though afflictions are cleared away, he manifests birth; though aging, sickness, and death are absent, he displays passing away. These beings, clinging to the swamp of name and form, wander on the wheel of cyclic existence like a wheel driven by the wind. Knowing that wandering beings are like deer that have entered a snare, one endowed with wisdom ranges freely, like a bird in the sky. Conduct that is wholly pure neither engages with form, nor engages with consciousness, perception, feeling, or thought. Practicing thus, one abandons all attachment, and, freed from attachment, one practices the wisdom of the Sugatas. The bodhisattva, luminously skilled in such practice, cuts through attachment and moves among beings without attachment — like the sun standing clear and bright, freed from Rāhu the eclipse-demon, or like a fire that burns grass, trees, and forest. When a bodhisattva views the Perfection of Wisdom, seeing that all phenomena are by nature pure, wholly pure, he does not apprehend an agent and does not apprehend any phenomenon at all — this is the practice of the supreme Perfection of Wisdom.

The fourth section teaches the realization of full manifest awakening in all aspects. The inquiry put to the Victor by Śakra, the king of the gods: "How does a bodhisattva strive in the practice of wisdom?" One does not strive even a particle toward the aggregates or the elements; not striving toward the aggregates — that is the bodhisattva's striving. Whoever hears that these phenomena are like an emanation and like an illusion, and without doubt turns back to the teaching, applying himself again and again — know that such a sentient being has long since entered the Great Vehicle; he has served more than ten billion hundreds of millions of buddhas. As a person who has traveled many leagues along the road through a wilderness, upon seeing a fine forest at the edge of a black cattle-herding district, thinks "These are signs that a

village or town is near," and gains relief and loses fear of bandits — so too, when one who earnestly seeks supreme awakening receives the opportunity to hear this Perfection of Wisdom of the Victors, know that he has gained relief and is without fear: he is not on the ground of an arhat, nor on the ground of one who has realized conditions alone. As a person who goes to see the waters of the ocean — if he still sees trees, forest, and mountains, it is still far off; but if those signs are not seen, one knows the great ocean is near, and concerning this there is no doubt — so too, one who has genuinely entered upon supreme awakening should know that by hearing this Perfection of Wisdom of the Victors, even though a guide has not yet directly prophesied it, awakening as a buddha is not far away; one will surely attain it. In the good season of spring, when a tree has burst into leaf —

the branches do not take long to put forth leaves, fruit, and flowers — so too, whoever obtains this Perfection of Wisdom of the Victors in hand will not take long to attain the awakening of those who guide beings.

For example, when a pregnant woman is beset by the pains of labor, one says that her time of giving birth has come. Likewise, a bodhisattva who hears the wisdom of the Victors, who gives rise to joy and aspiration, will swiftly touch awakening.

When a practitioner of yoga engages in this supreme Perfection of Wisdom, he does not perceive the increase or decrease of form. He who does not perceive phenomena or what is not phenomena within the dharmadhātu, and who does not touch upon nirvāṇa — he abides in wisdom.

He who, practicing here, does not conceptualize the qualities of buddhas, does not conceptualize powers, miraculous feet, awakening, or peace — he practices free from all conceptuality and conceptual elaboration, moved by blessing. This is the practice of the supreme Perfection of Wisdom.

Subhūti, the moon of speakers, then asked the Buddha: "What is it that cuts off the qualities and the joy of those who possess them?" The Teacher declared: "What cuts them off is many and various. Let me for now recount just a small portion. When one is copying this Perfection of Wisdom of the Victors, if a different kind of boldness arises and one abandons the welfare of beings and, swift as a lightning flash, falls into complete deterioration — this is the work of Māra.

"When this is being taught, some will be seized by doubt and think: 'The guide has not spoken my own name here, nor has he proclaimed my lineage, land, or

clan' — and at that thought they will not listen and will abandon it. This is the work of Māra.

"Not knowing in this way, such people cast away the root and, in their confusion, search for branches and leaves. Just as one who has found an elephant then searches for the elephant's tracks — seeking sūtras after having heard this Perfection of Wisdom is exactly like that.

"For example, it is as if someone who has found food with a hundred flavors, having found the finest of foods, then seeks inferior food. In just the same way, a bodhisattva who has found this Perfection of Wisdom but then seeks awakening through the ground of an arhat is exactly like that.

"One may wish for honor and wish for gain; one who is intimate with households through the minds of gods and men, who abandons the Dharma and engages in what is not Dharma, who having found the path then strays from it — this is the work of Māra.

"Those who at that time went with aspiration and faith to listen to this supreme Dharma, yet upon recognizing that one who speaks the Dharma is present, depart without joy and with a troubled mind — at that time this work of Māra will arise. And at that time, those who stir up and disturb the many monks so that they will not take hold of this Perfection of Wisdom — many other obstacles too will appear.

"Those who obtain something rare and priceless — because it is rare, they are always much harmed. In just the same way, this supreme Perfection of Wisdom of the Victors is a precious Dharma; it too is rare, and there is always much harm done against it. Māra rejoices in creating obstacles for the newly entered, small-minded sentient being who has not found this rare jewel. Apply yourself to being held by the buddhas of the ten directions.

"A mother who has fallen ill and has many children — all of them are distressed and care for her. Likewise, the buddhas of the world-realms of the ten directions attend with care to this supreme wisdom that has become their mother."

All the protectors of the world in the ten directions, of past times and of the ten directions, and those who will appear in times to come — all of them arise from this. This wisdom is the mother who gives birth to the Victors, the teachers of the world. She reveals the mental conduct of other sentient beings. She reveals the suchness of the world, the suchness of the arhat, the

suchness of the pratyekabuddha, and the suchness of the sons of the Victors.

Suchness — that oneness free from substantiality, not other —
the Perfection of Wisdom: the Tathāgata knows it.

Whether the wise one abides in the world or passes beyond sorrow,
this emptiness of phenomena, the nature of reality free from fault, remains.
The bodhisattva realizes this suchness in accordance with it,
and therefore the buddha is given the title "Tathāgata."

The Perfection of Wisdom, which rests in the garden of joy,
is the domain of those who lead beings — the holders of the ten powers.
Though they fully draw sentient beings forth from suffering and the three
lower destinies,
they never conceive of those beings as sentient beings.

Just as a lion, fearlessly dwelling on a mountain slope,
causes the many small deer to tremble and roars its cry —
so the lion among humans, relying on the Perfection of Wisdom,
causes the many non-Buddhists to tremble and roars throughout the world.

Just as the rays of the sun abiding in the sky
dry up this earth and clearly reveal all forms —
so the king of Dharma, relying on the Perfection of Wisdom,
dries up the river of craving and fully reveals the Dharma.

Forms are not seen; feelings too are not seen;
perception is not seen, and intention is not seen;
and where consciousness, mind, and mentation are not seen —
this the Tathāgata has taught to be the seeing of phenomena.

Sentient beings speak the words "I see the sky" —
yet examine how exactly one sees the sky and what it means.
In just that way has the Tathāgata taught the seeing of phenomena.
That seeing cannot be expressed through any other analogy.
Whoever sees in that way, sees all phenomena.

Just as a king sits in equanimity while his ministers do all the work,
so all the phenomena of the buddhas and the śrāvakas, however many they
are,
are all accomplished by the Perfection of Wisdom.

Just as a king does not go into the town, does not go around the district,
yet gathers all the assemblies from his own realm —

so the bodhisattva's nature of reality does not go anywhere,
yet gathers all the qualities of the ground of buddhahood.

Whoever has stable faith in the Sugata and the bodhisattvas,
and applies their mind to this supreme Perfection of Wisdom,
having utterly transcended the two grounds of the śrāvaka and the
pratyekabuddha,
swiftly attains the awakening of the Victors without being overpowered.

Just as when a ship setting out onto the ocean is wrecked,
and a person does not grasp at a corpse, or grass, or a plank —
they will perish in the midst of the water and will not reach the shore.
But whoever grasps hold of something will reach the far side of the ocean.

Likewise, if one who has attained faith and purity
does not follow the mother, the Perfection of Wisdom,
yet if they are entirely embraced by the qualities of skillful means and wisdom,
they will swiftly touch the awakening of the Sugata — most wondrous.

Just as when someone fires unfired clay and fills it with water,
because it is fragile it will quickly be understood to break.
But a fired vessel filled with water and carried along the road
will not break, and will arrive home safely and with ease.

Likewise, though a bodhisattva may be thoroughly steeped in faith,
if wisdom is lacking, they will quickly become unsuitable for awakening.
But if faith is fully embraced by wisdom,
they will utterly transcend the two grounds and attain the supreme
awakening.

Just as a well-made ship, if poorly repaired, will sink in the midst of the ocean
together with its cargo and merchants —
but if that ship is well repaired and well made,
it will not sink and will reach the shore with its cargo intact.

So too, even though a bodhisattva is thoroughly permeated by faith,
without wisdom they will quickly fall away from awakening.
But if that very one possesses the supreme Perfection of Wisdom,
without being harmed or diminished, they will touch the awakening of the
Victors.

Having reached a hundred and twenty years, old and afflicted —

though they rise, they cannot walk on their own.

But if they are supported by people on both left and right,
there is no fear of falling and they walk along with ease.

So too, a bodhisattva of weak wisdom,

though they have entered the path, will quickly decline.

But if that very one is fully held by supreme skillful means and wisdom,
they will touch the awakening of the Tathāgatas without decline.

Those who abide on the ground of a bodhisattva of initial deeds,
who with elevated aspiration have entered the supreme awakening of the
buddhas —

those who are good disciples and who revere their teacher
should always rely upon learned and wise teachers.

Why? Because the qualities of the learned arise from that.

These teachers point the way along the Perfection of Wisdom.

"The qualities of the buddhas and the Dharma depend upon a spiritual friend"

—

so spoke the Victor, who possesses the supreme of all qualities.

Generosity, moral discipline, patience, and likewise diligence,
meditative concentration and wisdom — dedicate all of these to awakening.

Do not cling to the heap of awakening and grasp it as supreme —
this is the instruction to be given to one of initial deeds.

Those who practice thus, the moons who speak of the ocean of virtue,
are refuge, ally, and dwelling place for beings.

They are support, intelligence, island, and guide for those who seek meaning,
illuminating lamp, speaker of the supreme Dharma, and undisturbed.

Those of great renown don the armor that is hard to don.

It is not the armor of the aggregates (skandhas), the elements (dhātus), or the
sense bases (āyatanas).

It is free of the perception of the three vehicles, and there is nothing to be
grasped.

It is non-regressing, unshaken, and undisturbed in its nature.

Those who are endowed with such qualities, free of conceptual elaboration,
rid of doubt and uncertainty, free of indecision, and rich in meaning —

one should know that upon hearing the Perfection of Wisdom, they do not
lament,

they do not rely upon others, they do not regress.

This Dharma of the guides is profound and difficult to see.

None whatsoever can realize or attain it.

Therefore, having attained awakening with love and for the benefit of others, the compassionate ones thought: "Who among the hosts of sentient beings could understand?" —

and put their minds at little anxiety.

Sentient beings delight in their abode and desire their objects, they dwell in grasping, the unintelligent, the foolish and dull, as though in darkness.

The Dharma to be attained has no fixed place and no object of grasping.

That is why conflict with the worlds arises.

The expanse of space — in the eastern direction and the southern direction, likewise in the western direction and the northern direction, boundless to the farthest edge,

in above, below, and however much exists in the ten directions — there is nothing become different, nothing become distinct.

The suchness of the past, the suchness of what is yet to come, the suchness of the present, the suchness of an arhat — the suchness of all phenomena, the suchness of the Victors — this suchness of all phenomena in the Dharma is undifferentiated.

What has arisen free from the qualities of difference between the awakening of the Sugatas:

this is what a bodhisattva who wishes to attain it

should, endowed with skillful means, apply themselves to the Perfection of Wisdom.

Without the wisdom of the guides, it cannot be attained.

Consider a bird whose body has grown to a size of a hundred and fifty leagues, but whose wings have wasted away and whose strength is gone —

if it leaps from the Heaven of the Thirty-Three down to this Jambudvīpa on its own,

it will come to harm and injury.

These five perfections of the Victors as well,

though cultivated through countless tens of millions of eons,

and though vast, limitless aspirations are maintained in the world always — without skillful means, lacking wisdom, one falls into the śrāvaka state.

Whoever wishes to emerge with certainty into the vehicle of the buddhas should, with an equanimous mind toward all beings, with the perception of mother and father, with a mind of benefiting and a spirit of loving-kindness, train oneself, and with impartiality and honesty speak gentle words.

Sthavira Subhūti asked the Protector of the World:

"O ocean of qualities, please show the signs of being free from afflictions. Just as the mighty do not turn back again, so please, Victor, prophesy even a fraction of those qualities."

Free from the perception of separation, speaking words endowed with reason, one does not take refuge in other ascetics (śramaṇas) and brahmins.

The wise constantly abandon the three lower realms, and apply themselves diligently to the path of the ten virtuous actions.

Without material expectation, they teach Dharma to beings by following after them.

They delight in Dharma alone and always speak gentle words.

Whether walking, moving about, lying down, or sitting, they are thoroughly endowed with vigilance.

They look only as far as a yoke's length ahead, and their mind is not confused as they move.

Keeping their body clean and wearing clean robes, the three — body, speech, and mind — are in solitude and purity.

They do not seek gain; foremost among the herd, they always desire Dharma.

They have passed beyond the realm of Māra and do not rely on others.

They cultivate the four meditative concentrations, yet do not remain attached to those states of concentration.

They do not seek fame; their mind is not bound by anger.

Though they become householders, they are never attached to any possessions whatsoever.

For the sake of livelihood, they do not seek wealth through dishonest means.

They do not practice violent spells or mantras for binding women,

and they do not teach that one who performs acts of desire will be reborn as a man or woman.

They strive earnestly in the supreme perfection of wisdom through thorough seclusion.

Free from fighting and quarreling, they are also steady in a mind of

loving-kindness.

Desiring omniscience and steady, they are possessed of a mind ever inclined toward it.

They completely abandon the borderlands inhabited by barbarian peoples.

In their own domain they are without suspicion, always like Mount Meru.

For the sake of Dharma they even cast aside their lives, and strive earnestly in yoga.

These are to be known as the signs of non-return.

Form, feeling, perception, mental formations, and consciousness are profound — without inherent nature, without characteristics, utterly pacified.

Just as one who seeks the bottom of the ocean with an arrow does not reach it, so, when examined with wisdom, the depths of the aggregates are not found.

Whatever bodhisattva has become thus profound, who has realized this Dharma of the ultimate vehicle, without attachment, in which aggregates, elements, and sense bases do not exist — what merit truly accomplished could there be greater than that?

For example, take a man engaged in the Dharma of desire who has arranged a tryst with a woman yet does not meet her.

As many mental thoughts and activities arise in his mind throughout one day, so many eons will a bodhisattva take to attain awakening through that path.

Yet a bodhisattva who, through countless tens of millions of eons, gives to arhats and pratyekabuddhas and maintains moral discipline — the good of speaking even a word of Dharma possessing the supreme Perfection of Wisdom surpasses that giving and that moral discipline.

A bodhisattva who has cultivated the supreme wisdom, who then rises from it and teaches the unstained Dharma, and who, for the sake of beings' welfare, dedicates it as a cause for awakening —

there is nothing in the three worlds equal to that virtue.

That merit, too, should be known as accumulated, yet equally empty, as a husk, as a skeleton, as marrow, and as without essence.

When one thus practices and sustains the wisdom of the Sugatas, one fully grasps immeasurable merit in the act of practicing.

Knowing that all these Dharmas, which the buddhas have taught, practiced,
and demonstrated,
are exhausted in mere words —
though one speaks them throughout countless tens of millions upon billions of
eons,
in the dharmadhātu there is neither exhaustion nor increase.

Whatever is called "the perfections of the Victors" —
those dharmas too are thoroughly proclaimed as names only.
A bodhisattva who fully dedicates without the conceit of dedication
will be without decline and will attain the supreme awakening of a buddha.

Like sesame oil and its essence: upon first contact
the essence is not burned by a word, nor does it vanish without a word.
The final tongue of flame does not burn the essence,
yet without the final flame the essence is also not burned.
So too, the first moment of mind does not reach supreme awakening,
yet without that final moment it cannot be reached.
The last moment of mind does not attain the peaceful awakening,
yet without it that attainment is also impossible.

From a seed arise a sprout, a flower, and fruit,
and yet when the seed has ceased, the tree is not found there —
just so, the first moment of mind is itself a cause of awakening,
and yet when it has ceased, awakening is not in that moment either.

As drops of water fill a jar from the first drop to the last,
little by little, gradually filling it to fullness —
just so, the first moment of mind is a cause of supreme awakening,
and gradually, through the completion of white qualities, one becomes a
buddha.

Practicing the Dharma of emptiness, signlessness, and wishlessness,
not touching nirvāṇa, not engaging in signs —
like a skilled archer shooting his arrows, moving back and forth,
yet dwelling at neither extreme and not remaining in the ocean —
a bodhisattva who practices in this way has no thought of "I
shall be prophesied by the ten powers and shall touch awakening."
Nor does the thought "there is nothing here" frighten him away from
awakening.

Such practice is the practice of the wisdom of the Sugata (the Well-Gone One,

the Buddha).

Seeing the world as a desolate path beset with famine and disease,
one is without fear; from that point one dons the armor,
strives without cease to the very end of the future,
and does not produce even a trace of a despairing mind.

A bodhisattva who practices the wisdom of the Victors,
knowing that these aggregates have been empty and unborn from the very
beginning,
enters into compassion for the realm of sentient beings even outside of
meditative equipoise,
and in that intermediate period does not fall away at all from the Dharma of
the buddhas.

Consider a skilled person endowed with all qualities,
possessed of strength and tireless effort, knowing arts and crafts and rituals,
who has gone to the far shore in many trades and crafts,
knows how to perform illusions, and has a deep wish to benefit beings.
Having gathered together his father, his mother, and his wife,
he travels along a desolate road beset with many enemies.
He, being courageous and bold, conjures up many illusory persons,
goes along safely and returns home again.

Just so, the bodhisattva who is skilled and clear-sighted,
generating great compassion for all the realms of sentient beings,
thoroughly passing beyond the four māras and the two grounds as well,
abides in supreme meditative absorption and yet does not touch awakening.

Wind rests upon space; upon wind rests a mass of water;
upon that the great earth rests; upon that beings rest.
The cause that underlies the activities and actions of sentient beings is of just
such a nature —
contemplate what meaning it is that space contains.

Likewise, a bodhisattva abiding in emptiness,
supported by aspirational prayers and the awareness of sentient beings as
beings,
manifests many and various activities,
does not touch nirvāṇa, and does not abide in emptiness as though fixed
there.

When a wise and luminous bodhisattva practices this supreme meditative absorption of peaceful emptiness, in that intermediate period he does not meditate upon signs at all; he dwells without signs, at peace, practicing in utter stillness.

A bird flying through open space does not dwell there — not dwelling there, it does not fall to the ground.

Likewise, a bodhisattva who practices through the doors of liberation does not touch nirvāṇa and does not practice in signs.

Consider a person trained in archery who shoots an arrow into the sky: he strings other arrows in succession so that each follows the one before, so that the earlier arrow never finds an occasion to fall to earth — yet if that person wished it, the arrow would indeed fall to the ground.

In the same way, one who practices the supreme Perfection of Wisdom, conducting oneself through wisdom, skillful means, powers, and miraculous ability —

for as long as the roots of virtue are not complete, for so long does one not attain that supreme emptiness.

Consider a monk endowed with the highest powers of miraculous ability: dwelling in the sky, he performs magical displays all at once, manifesting going, walking, lying down, and sitting — and yet he is without weariness and without fatigue in all of this.

Likewise, a wise bodhisattva who abides in emptiness — displaying limitless activities for all beings, without weariness and without fatigue across ten million aeons.

Consider a person who stands at the edge of a great precipice, holding an umbrella in each hand, who leaps into the sky and, having cast their body over the great abyss, does not fall for as long as they continue moving through the air.

Likewise, a wise bodhisattva who abides in compassion, grasping the two umbrellas of skillful means and wisdom, contemplates all phenomena as empty, signless, and wishless, does not touch nirvāṇa, and yet perceives the Dharma.

Consider one who desires jewels and sails to a jewel-isle, finds those jewels, and then returns home again.

There the merchant alone lives at ease,

and does not place his friends and companions in discomfort.

Likewise, a bodhisattva who has gone to the jewel-isle of emptiness,
who has attained the powers of meditative concentration,
takes delight only in touching nirvāṇa
and does not lay to heart the sufferings of sentient beings.

Consider a merchant who travels through whatever towns, villages,
and settlements lie along the way, seeking profit and wishing to learn the
route.

He does not stay there, nor does he stay at the jewel-isle,
nor does he rest at home — he becomes expert in the path.

Likewise, a bodhisattva who is clear-sighted becomes expert in all the forms of
liberation

of śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas.

He does not dwell there; the wisdom of the buddhas is not his dwelling-place.
He does not dwell in the unconditioned, and yet he knows the manner of the
path.

When one has connected beings to loving-kindness
and practices meditative absorption that is empty, signless, and wishless —
can it be said that such a one has attained nirvāṇa,
or can it be designated as conditioned? That one is without a fixed abode.

Consider a magically created human body: it is not invisible,
and yet it can be designated by name.

Likewise, a bodhisattva who moves through the gates of liberation
can still be designated by name.

If, when one's conduct and faculties are fully examined,
a bodhisattva does not fully teach the Dharma of emptiness and signlessness,
and the Dharma of the irreversible ground is not interrupted —
that is to be understood as neither affirmed nor denied by scripture.

The fifth section teaches the full and perfect realization of the summit.

The wisdom of arhats and of those buddhas who awaken through conditions,
who even in dreams have no desire for the three realms,
who behold the buddhas and teach the Dharma to beings —
that is to be understood as a prophecy of irreversibility.

One who in a dream sees sentient beings dwelling in the three lower realms,
and in that very instant makes aspiration prayers to sever the stream of the
lower realms,
and through the power of truth's blessing quenches a mass of fire —
that is to be understood as a prophecy of irreversibility.

One who, in a human world filled with spirits and many diseases,
pacifies them through the power of truth with benefit and heartfelt
compassion,
and yet is without conceit and without the arising of pride —
that is to be understood as a prophecy of irreversibility.

If, however, the thought of conceit should arise —
"Because I have gained these various powers of truth's blessing, I have been
prophesied" —
or if a bodhisattva should take pride in being prophesied by another,
the one in whom such conceit abides is to be known as of small intelligence.

A māra approaches from the ground of names and addresses one thus:
"This name is yours, and it was the name of your father and mother,
and of all who came before you down to seven generations.
It is the very name by which you will become a buddha.
What kind of training, vows, and yoga will arise?
And your former qualities and manner of conduct were just such as this."

A bodhisattva who hears such words and becomes conceited
is to be known as fully stirred up by māra and of small intelligence.

One who frequents deeply secluded villages and towns, mountain ravines,
hermitages, wilderness places, and forest groves,
yet praises oneself while disparaging others —
that bodhisattva is to be known as fully stirred up by māra and of small
intelligence.

One who perpetually dwells in towns, villages, and hamlets
for the purpose of ripening sentient beings and striving for awakening,
and in whom no wish other than that of an arhat or pratyekabuddha arises —
such solitude, the Sugatas' sons have said, is real solitude.

A bodhisattva who dwells for many thousands of years
in a mountain ravine five hundred leagues across,
filled with snakes,

yet does not understand this solitude
has fallen into the company of spirits (pretas) by seizing upon an inflated
pride.

A bodhisattva who strives with diligence for the benefit of beings,
who has attained meditative concentration, the powers, the faculties, the
liberations, and samādhi —
one who looks down on such a person thinking, "This is no life of forest
seclusion,"
dwells, the Victor has said, within the domain of māra.

Whether one dwells in a village or in a hermitage,
if one is free from the mind of both vehicles and resolved upon supreme
awakening,
that is the solitude of those who have entered the service of beings.
A bodhisattva who turns lukewarm will suffer the ruin of his own realization.

Therefore, one who seeks supreme awakening,
possessed of resolute intention and wisdom, having decisively subdued
conceit,
should, just as an assembly of sick people relies on a physician to be healed,
rely upon a spiritual friend without slackening.

Bodhisattvas who have entered upon buddha-awakening, the supreme
awakening,
should rely upon them along with the perfections as their spiritual friend.
Those who guide others in the footsteps of this practice —
this is the ground of accomplishment.
By means of these two causes, buddha-awakening is swiftly realized.

All the Victors of the past, future, and those dwelling in the ten directions —
for all of them the path was none other than these perfections.
These perfections, it is said, are the light, the lamp, the radiance, and the
supreme guide
for those who have entered upon supreme awakening.

Just as the Perfection of Wisdom is characterized by emptiness,
one should know that all these phenomena share that same characteristic.
And if one thoroughly understands that phenomena are empty and without
marks,
to conduct oneself accordingly is to practice the wisdom of the Sugata.

Sentient beings, utterly famished, crave food,
and those whose minds are attached to saṃsāra circle without end.
Self and what belongs to self — both are empty, not truly existent.
In their childishness, ordinary beings cast knots into the sky.

For example, when one is made to ingest poison through the perception of suspicion,

the poison, though it has not actually entered, causes one to faint.

Likewise, ordinary beings who affirm self and what belongs to self —
the perception of that very self, impermanent and subject to arising and
perishing, arises truly for them.

As one clings, so does affliction fully manifest throughout.

Not perceiving self and what belongs to self is proclaimed as purification.

In regard to this, a bodhisattva who realizes the Perfection of Wisdom
understands that no affliction can be purified while remaining unchanging.

However many sentient beings there are in Jambudvīpa without exception —
if all of them were to arouse the mind set on supreme awakening
and were to practice generosity for many tens of millions of years,
dedicating all of it as a cause for awakening for the benefit of beings —
yet if someone devotes earnest effort to practicing the supreme Perfection of
Wisdom

and accords with it even for a single day,

the mass of merit from that generosity cannot match it.

Therefore, without slackening, one should always engage in wisdom.

A yogin who practices the supreme Perfection of Wisdom,
though arousing great compassion, holds no perception of sentient beings as
such.

At that time the wise one becomes a field of generosity for all beings
and always, going about among villages and districts on alms-round, practices
meaningfully and completely.

A bodhisattva who has long been connected to this place,
wishing to teach the vast path of the perfections to the realm of sentient
beings —

gods, humans, and those of the three lower destinies — in order to liberate
them,

Day and night one should strive in the Perfection of Wisdom.

A supremely precious jewel that a person had never before found,
found at last on some other occasion, and overjoyed,
if through carelessness one loses it the very moment it is found,
then, having lost it, one forever aches with longing for that jewel.

Likewise, the yogin must not abandon the Perfection of Wisdom,
which is like a precious jewel entered upon in supreme awakening.
Just as one who has found a jewel, having taken it up and bound it securely
with diligent effort,
moves swiftly onward until reaching peace —

so too the sun, its rays spread wide, free from clouds,
rising to vanquish all dense and heavy darkness,
outshines the firefly, every living creature and spirit,
all the hosts of stars, and the full light of the moon.

Likewise, the bodhisattva who practices the Perfection of Wisdom,
dwelling in supreme conduct, practicing emptiness and the signless,
through wisdom shatters the dense thicket of [wrong] views and, going forth,
utterly outshines all beings, all arhats, all pratyekabuddhas, and the multitude
of [ordinary] awakening minds.

Take the example of a prince who, wishing to distribute wealth, is fit to stand
at the head of all
and to set out openly in that role —
yet even in that lesser station he gladdens multitudes of beings;
what need is there to speak of his position once he has obtained the means
and sits on the royal throne?

Likewise, the bodhisattva who is skilled in the practice of wisdom
bestows nectar and gladdens gods and humans alike.
Even in that lesser station he strives to benefit multitudes of beings;
what need is there to speak of his position once he is established as the
Dharma king?

At that time Māra becomes afflicted with a thorn of anguish,
wretched with distress, suffering, mental unease, and dejection,
wondering how this bodhisattva has come to be gladdened,
and so, to inspire terror, he sets the directions ablaze and hurls meteor arrows.

But whenever those wise ones are possessed of strong resolve
and day and night attend to the supreme meaning of the Perfection of

Wisdom,

at that time body and mind move through the sky like birds in flight —
how could the dark forces with all their stratagems find any opening?

Yet when bodhisattvas fall into fighting and disputing,
harboring minds of mutual hostility and anger,
at that time Māra rejoices and takes supreme delight,
thinking that these two have grown far from the wisdom of the Victors.

Those two grow distant and become like cannibals toward each other,
both breaking their own pledges and commitments.
Where there is hatred, where patience is absent, how can awakening be
found?

At that time Māra and all his hosts rejoice together.

When a bodhisattva who has not received a prophecy
begins to quarrel in anger with one who has received a prophecy,
for as many moments as that faulty and defective mind persists,
for that many eons the armor of merit is stripped away from the ground up.

A buddha touches awakening through the Perfection of Patience.
Yet if one produces the thought that this mind is not good,
and clings to things separately, and then restrains oneself afterward,
without rejoicing — that is what one studies in the Dharma of the buddhas.

When one studies and yet does not accept any training as such,
not apprehending the student, not apprehending the dharmas of training,
not conceptualizing these two — training and what is not training —
whoever studies in that way, that one studies in the Dharma of the buddhas.

Whatever bodhisattva knows this kind of training,
that one will not, even elsewhere, fall into broken conduct or impaired moral
discipline.

That one studies this in order to please the buddhas in the Dharma.

That one is skilled in training that transcends training, without any
apprehension of an object.

It is in just this way that the wisdom of the wise illuminators is trained.

They do not give rise to even a single moment of non-virtuous mind.

Just as in the sky before the sun, whose rays course through the heavens and
overwhelm all,

no darkness remains in the expanse of space ahead —

so too, for those who have trained in the Perfection of Wisdom,
all the perfections come to be gathered here in this one.
Just as the sixty-two views are said to be subsumed within the view of the
transitory collection,
likewise it is taught that all these perfections are subsumed in this.

For example, if the faculty of the life-force is cut off, all other faculties —
all that exist, however many, cease.

Likewise, for the supreme wise ones who train in the Perfection of Wisdom,
all the perfections are taught to be gathered here in this one.

Those skilled in the awakening mind (bodhicitta) train in whatever qualities the
śrāvakas possess,
and likewise train in all the qualities of the solitary buddhas
(pratyekabuddhas),
yet they do not abide in those, nor do they give rise to any desire for them.
They train because they think: "This is what I must train in."

Toward the arising of the mind directed toward supreme, irreversible
awakening,
they rejoice with deep and sincere intention.

The merit of that rejoicing cannot be measured even by weighing Mount Meru
on a scale against the triple-thousand world-system —
and yet the merit of such rejoicing is not even like that.

Toward however many sentient beings there are who seek virtue and wish for
benefit,
one has rejoiced in every mass of their accumulated merit.
Therefore, having thus obtained the qualities of the Victors,
in order to bring suffering to exhaustion, one gives the Dharma to the world.

A bodhisattva who does not conceptualize any phenomena,
who thoroughly knows emptiness, signlessness, and freedom from conceptual
elaboration —

that one does not seek awakening by means of two kinds of wisdom,
and that yogin (Skt. yogin) strives in the supreme Perfection of Wisdom.

Just as there can be no contradiction between the element of space and space
itself,

and no one whatsoever has attained it —
so too the bodhisattva skilled in the Perfection of Wisdom

is like space and dwells in perfect peace.

In the midst of ordinary people, like a conjured illusory man,
one does not think "I will please these people" — and yet one does so.
Even while appearing to display all manner of miraculous powers,
that conjured man has no body, no mind, not even a name.
So too, one who trains in the Perfection of Wisdom never thinks:
"Having realized awakening, I will liberate all beings" —
yet appearing like an illusion with various births and manifold deeds,
one acts without conceptual thought.

For example, a magical emanation of a buddha performs the deeds of a buddha,
yet in the doing of those deeds, not even a trace of pride arises.
So too, the bodhisattva skilled in the Perfection of Wisdom
displays all deeds like an emanation, like an illusion.

Just as a master carpenter skilled in his craft fashions a figure resembling a woman —
that figure too performs all the actions —
so too, the bodhisattva skilled in the Perfection of Wisdom
performs all deeds through non-conceptual wisdom (jñāna).

Thus, many assemblies of gods, toward those skilled in such conduct,
join their palms in reverence and bow down in homage.
All the buddhas of however many world-realms in the ten directions
fully pronounce garlands of praises of their qualities.

Even if, in a field equal to as many grains of sand as there are in the Gaṅgā River,
all the sentient beings were to take on the full examination of all of that and
become māras,
and were to produce that many emanations from each and every single hair-pore —
none of them would be able to create any obstacle for one who is skilled.

By four causes, a bodhisattva who is skilled and possessed of power
is difficult to overcome by the four māras, and cannot be moved:
abiding in emptiness, not abandoning sentient beings,
acting in accordance with what one has declared, and possessing the blessing
of the Sugata.

This Perfection of Wisdom, the mother of the Tathāgatas —
when it is being taught, whatever bodhisattva has faith in it,
and strives with deep and sincere intention to realize it,
let it be known that such a one has entered into omniscience itself.

Without abiding in the dharmadhātu or in suchness (tathatā),
one abides without abiding, like clouds in the intermediate sky.
A holder of vidyā mantras (Skt. vidyā), seeking a dwelling-place, wandering
space without fixed abode,
through the power of mantra causes unseasonable flowers to bloom and
blesses.

Thus, the bodhisattva who is skilled and luminous in such conduct
causes realization to arise, yet does not apprehend the phenomena of
buddhas;
one teaches, and does not apprehend those who wish for Dharma as viewers.
This is the abode of rejoicing in qualities desired by those who seek peace.

Apart from the liberation of arhats and Tathāgatas,
this abode — together with that of śrāvakas and solitary buddhas —
is an abode of peaceful meditative absorption, supremely peaceful and
blissful:
it is the highest of all however many there are, unsurpassed and supreme.

A winged creature dwells in the sky yet does not fall.
A fish dwells in water yet is not drowned and does not die.
Just so, the bodhisattva, through the power of meditative concentration,
dwells in the emptiness beyond, yet does not pass into nirvāṇa.

To advance the highest qualities of all sentient beings,
to touch the supreme and wondrous pinnacle of buddha-wisdom,
and to give the highest, most sacred gift of Dharma to all who desire it —
those who bestow this benefit should rely upon this supreme abode.

When the guide proclaims this training in its entirety,
it is the highest of all trainings, unsurpassed and supreme.
Whoever among the wise wishes to go beyond all trainings
should learn here the Perfection of Wisdom, the training of buddhas.

This is the supreme treasury of Dharma, the sacred storehouse of Dharma.
It is of the lineage of buddhas, the treasury of happiness and well-being for all
beings.

The protectors of the world in the ten directions, past and future,
are born from this, yet the dharmadhātu is never exhausted.

However many trees, fruits, flowers, and forests there may be,
all of them arise and emerge from the earth without exception;
yet the earth is neither diminished nor increased,
it is never impaired, free from conceptual elaboration, and without weariness.

However many things of happiness and well-being there are
for the sons of buddhas, śrāvakas, solitary buddhas, gods,
and all beings —
all of these arise from the supreme Perfection of Wisdom,
yet that wisdom is neither diminished nor increased.

However many sentient beings there are — inferior, middling, and superior —
all of them, the Sugata declared, arise from ignorance.
When conditions gather, the mechanism of suffering fully arises.
That mechanism of ignorance is inexhaustible and does not increase.

However many aspects, gateways, methods, and roots of wisdom there may
be,
all of these arise from the supreme Perfection of Wisdom.
When conditions gather, the mechanism of karma fully arises.
Yet the Perfection of Wisdom is inexhaustible and does not increase.

Whatever bodhisattva understands dependent origination,
knowing through this wisdom that it is unborn and inexhaustible,
will — like the sun when cloudless rays scatter and dispel the darkness —
crush the dense mass of ignorance and attain the self-arisen.

Though one of great power abides in the four meditative concentrations,
one does not rely upon them and there is no one who abides in them.
Yet these four meditative concentrations with their branches
become the support for attaining the highest and supreme awakening.

Having attained supreme wisdom, one who abides in the pure concentrations
also experiences the four noble formless absorptions.
These concentrations serve the highest supreme awakening;
the bodhisattva does not train in them for the exhaustion of defilements.

This is the wondrous marvel of an accumulation of qualities:
abiding in meditative concentration and samādhi, one is free of marks.

If those who abide therein should find their body breaking apart,
they are reborn in the desire realm according to their wish and aspiration.

For example, a person of Jambudvīpa who had not previously gone
to the supreme divine city of the god-realms, and then went later —
having seen those lands that were fully apprehended and perceived,
should they return here, they would feel no attachment.

Just so, a bodhisattva who holds the highest qualities,
striving in yoga and abiding in meditative concentration and samādhi,
then again dwells in the desire realm, yet has no attachment —
like a lotus in water, not resting in the ways of the childish.

A great being's sole purpose is to ripen sentient beings,
to purify buddha-fields, and to complete the perfections.
Thinking that the qualities and perfections of awakening might decline,
one does not seek rebirth in the formless realm.

For example, a person who has found a treasure of jewels
but has not given rise to a mind of desire for them,
and who at some other time takes up those very jewels
and, having taken them, goes home — yet feels no attachment.

Just so, the skilled bodhisattva, joyful and bliss-giving,
having attained the four peaceful meditative concentrations and samādhis,
sets aside those blissful concentrations and samādhis —

and, out of compassion for beings, enters the desire realm once more.

If a bodhisattva who dwells in samādhi and meditative concentration
were to give rise to a mind that desires the vehicle of the arhat or the
pratyekabuddha,
that one would be without meditative equipoise, scattered and mentally
distracted —
like a vessel taking on water, all the qualities of buddhahood would be entirely
lost.

Furthermore, even if one strives earnestly after the five sensual objects —
form, sound, smell, taste, and touch —
yet takes delight in the bodhisattva's awakening mind, free from the vehicle of
the arhat and the pratyekabuddha,
one should know that such a hero is always in meditative equipoise.

The bodhisattva who is pure, acting for the sake of other sentient beings and persons,

engages with vigorous diligence in the perfection of diligence.

Just as a maidservant, without power of her own, is under her master's command,

so the heroes move entirely under the command of all sentient beings.

Whether she is verbally abused or beaten without ceasing,

the maidservant utters no word of refusal to her master.

Thinking, "By this one I may be killed,"

with a mind utterly terrified, she overwhelms her fear and endures.

Just so, one who has entered the supreme path for the sake of awakening should remain as though a servant to all beings.

By this, awakening will be attained and all qualities will be perfected.

Just as fire arises from grass and wood and burns the very substance from which it sprang,

so, having set aside one's own happiness and with a mind of no expectation, one strives day and night with diligence for the needs of other sentient beings.

Just as a mother tends her only child

with heartfelt resolve, remain unwearied and without despondency.

The bodhisattva who for a long time desires cyclic existence,

who is a yogin diligent in the welfare of sentient beings and the purification of buddha-fields —

if not even a particle of a despondent attitude arises in that one,

then that one is endowed with the perfection of diligence, never slack.

An unskilled bodhisattva may count countless eons,

and if one cultivates the perception that pursuing awakening is long and painful,

then when one actually practices the true Dharma, it will become long and painful —

and that one has degraded the perfection of diligence and become lazy.

From the very first moment of arousing the mind set on supreme awakening until the attainment of unsurpassed awakening,

if one contemplates it as a single day and night,

the wise, being clear-sighted, should know that diligence has been undertaken.

If someone were to say, "After Mount Meru is ground to dust,
then you will attain supreme awakening" —
if even a trace of a despondent attitude were to arise in one's mind at that
moment,
then that bodhisattva has become lazy.

But if one thinks, "What is this little measure — how can it be difficult?"
and arouses the mind to reduce Mount Meru to dust in a single instant —
that bodhisattva is skilled, having undertaken diligence,
and will swiftly, without long delay, attain the supreme awakening that leads
beings onward.

If one strives with body, speech, and mind, thinking "I shall ripen beings
completely and accomplish their welfare,"
yet abides with the perception of a self, one has become lazy
and will be as far from omniscience as heaven is from earth.

When one is without the perceptions of body, mind, and sentient being,
and having reversed mistaken perceptions, practices the Dharma free from
duality —
this is what has been taught by the Beneficent One as the perfection of
diligence,
for those who wish for the supreme, peaceful, undecaying awakening.

If one hears harsh and rough words spoken ill of oneself by another,
the skilled bodhisattva rejoices, thinking "I am well."
Who speaks, who hears, by what, of what, and for what reason —
one who is wise, endowed with the supreme perfection of patience,
understands.

A bodhisattva who possesses the excellent quality of patience —
were one to fill this entire triple-thousand world system with precious jewels
and offer them,
known to the world, to the buddhas, the arhats, and the pratyekabuddhas —
even that great heap of generosity could not surpass the merit of the patient
one.

The body of one who abides in patience becomes utterly purified;
it bears the thirty-two major marks and power and strength without limit,
and proclaims the Dharma to sentient beings a thousand times in its fullness.

The wise one who possesses patience becomes beloved by all beings. If some sentient beings take a sandalwood stake and with great spite drive it into a bodhisattva, while another scatters burning embers upon his head — toward both of these one should cultivate a mind that is even and equanimous. The skilled bodhisattva, having thus practised patience, arouses the mind of awakening and fully dedicates it to the supreme awakening. That hero, by means of patience toward all in the world, surpasses the arhats, the pratyekabuddhas, and all the vast multitudes of sentient beings.

One should arouse the thought: "I shall practise patience" — for beings in the hells, in the animal realm, and in the world of Yama's realm endure abundant suffering; those under the power of desire, driven by its causes, experience harm against their will. "For the sake of awakening, why should I not bear this now?"

Whether struck with a cane or a weapon, slain, bound, or beaten, whether one's head is cut off or one's ears, hands, feet, or nose severed — however much worldly suffering there may be, I shall endure it. The bodhisattva abides in the perfection of patience.

Those who desire peace through moral discipline become noble. They dwell within the domain of the ten powers, and their moral discipline is without impairment. They enter into all the activities of the vows and dedicate them likewise to awakening for the benefit of all sentient beings.

If one desires to attain the awakening of an arhat or a pratyekabuddha, yet one's moral discipline is corrupt and one's conduct unskilled and degenerate — but if instead one fully dedicates everything to the supreme peaceful awakening — then, even while striving after the pleasures of the senses, one abides in the perfection of moral discipline.

Whatever Dharma gives rise to the qualities of definitive awakening — this is the meaning of moral discipline for those endowed with virtue. Whatever Dharma causes the complete deterioration of awakening for those who act with benefit — this, the guide has declared, is corrupt moral discipline.

Even if a bodhisattva enjoys the five sense pleasures, if he has gone for refuge to the Buddha, the Dharma, and the noble Saṅgha, and if with omniscience as his mental orientation he aspires to accomplish buddhahood — the wise should know that he abides in the perfection of moral discipline.

If one were to practise the ten paths of virtuous action for ten million aeons, yet were to generate desire for the state of arhat or pratyekabuddha — at that point a fault in moral discipline arises and one's moral discipline is degenerate. Indeed, generating the mind of awakening and then abandoning it is an even graver defeat than a root downfall.

Guarding moral discipline and fully dedicating it to the supreme awakening, one has no pride and does not praise oneself; one completely abandons the perception of "I" and the perception of "sentient being." This is said to describe a bodhisattva who abides in the perfection of moral discipline.

If a bodhisattva who walks the Victor's path enters into various discriminations — thinking "these sentient beings keep the precepts, those have broken the precepts" — this is gravely corrupt moral discipline. With degenerate moral discipline, there is for such a one no pure moral discipline whatsoever. For one in whom there is no perception of self and no perception of sentient being, and in whom perception is free from attachment — how could there be a vow or its absence? For one in whom there is neither a vow nor the conceit of having no vow — this, the guide has declared, is pure moral discipline and restraint.

A sentient being who is pure and thus morally disciplined holds no view toward either the pleasant or the unpleasant. He gives away his head and his limbs without any shrinking of mind; he gives away all his possessions and is never attached to anything.

Understanding that all phenomena are by their intrinsic nature without self — clear and pellucid — if one gives away even one's own flesh without any shrinking of mind, then what need is there to speak of giving away external things? There is no basis for being miserly.

Through perceiving a self and clinging to things as one's own, attachment arises. How could fools ever develop a mind of generosity? Those who are miserly are reborn in the realm of the hungry ghosts. And even if born as a human, they are then poor.

Therefore the bodhisattva, understanding the poverty of sentient beings, becomes devoted to giving and gives freely at all times. Though the four continents beautifully adorned were no more than the ash of a spittle — giving them away one would feel joy. Yet obtaining those continents is not like that.

The wise and radiant bodhisattva thinks, "May this giving be given to every sentient being, however many there are throughout the three realms of

existence," and so gives with that intention. That giving, too, is dedicated to supreme awakening for the benefit of all beings.

Having given, one does not abide in the thing given. Nor does one ever set one's hopes on karmic maturation from it. A skilled giver in this way gives everything, and by giving little, immeasurable abundance comes about.

Taking as one's concern a full contemplation of all sentient beings without exception throughout the three realms of existence, and then rejoicing in all the acts of giving that all of those beings perform — if one who seeks the good as a hearer were to give for endless ages to the buddhas who know the world, to arhats and solitary buddhas — a wise bodhisattva who, through skillful means, rejoices in the very actuality of those meritorious deeds, and then dedicates all of it to the highest awakening for the sake of sentient beings: by such complete dedication, that bodhisattva surpasses the entire giving of all beings.

Even a great heap of gems and pearls is surpassed by a single gem of lapis lazuli. In the same way, the bodhisattva surpasses by rejoicing the vast accumulations of giving by all beings.

If a bodhisattva has given to beings, has not made it his own, and has no attachment to things — from that, the root of virtue grows with great power, like the orb of the moon in its waxing fortnight, bright and free of cloud.

The sixth section, which teaches the completion of the topic: the bodhisattva's generosity cuts off the destiny of hungry ghosts, and likewise cuts off poverty and all afflictions. During one's life, one attains an inexhaustible and flourishing wealth of enjoyment. Through generosity, one brings to full maturation those sentient beings caught in suffering.

Through ethical discipline, one turns away from the many forms of the animal destiny and the eight states of non-leisure, thereby always finding leisure. Through patience, one attains a noble and vast beauty of form — a golden complexion, lovely and worthy of beholding by all beings. Through diligence, virtuous qualities do not diminish, and one finds the inexhaustible treasury of the Victor's gnosis. Through meditative concentration, one abandons clinging to the qualities of desire and fully accomplishes higher knowledge, clairvoyance, and samādhi. Through wisdom, one fully knows the intrinsic nature of phenomena and passes entirely beyond the three realms without remainder.

As the supreme lord among men, encircled by a precious wheel, one teaches the Dharma to beings so as to bring suffering to an end.

The seventh section, which teaches the attainment of perfect and complete awakening in a single instant: having perfected all these dharmas, that bodhisattva —

The eighth section, which teaches the dharmakāya: holds a fully purified field and fully grasps purified sentient beings, holds the lineage of the buddhas and the lineage of the Dharma in full, and likewise holds the lineage of the Saṅgha and all phenomena in full. Becoming the supreme healer who cures the sickness of beings, one proclaims this teaching of wisdom, this path to awakening, saying: the name of this path to awakening is "Gathering Precious Qualities." This path is taught so that every sentient being may attain it.

The noble Perfection of Wisdom in verse, the Gathering, is complete.

This was translated, edited, and established by the Indian preceptor Vidyākaraśiṃha and the great translator-monk Paldetseg.

Translator's Notes

- The text breaks off mid-stanza with the final verse incomplete, as the source passage ends there. The translation faithfully renders only what is present.

The phrase rendered "abides in wisdom" for the bodhisattva who "does not touch nirvāṇa" reflects the classical Mahāyāna teaching that the bodhisattva, realizing emptiness, neither falls into saṃsāra nor takes a nirvāṇa of mere cessation — a doctrinally significant point preserved here.

The expression "abides here, at peace in themselves" renders the Tibetan idiom for settled, non-conceptual meditative presence without adding doctrinal color beyond what the verse carries.

- The stanza beginning "If one arouses a perception of sentient beings" presents a deliberate doctrinal paradox: the text acknowledges that one may genuinely be a bodhisattva while still falling short of true Perfection of Wisdom practice if one reifies self and beings. The rendering follows this tension closely.

The simile of the magician cutting off heads is a classical Perfection of Wisdom image: just as the slain figures are illusory emanations and no real killing occurs, so the bodhisattva who knows all beings as illusory-like emanations acts for their benefit without fear, because no substantial self or other is at stake.

The phrase rendered "the Mother of the Victors" refers to the Perfection of Wisdom herself, conceived as the mother who gives birth to all buddhas — a standard epithet in this literature.

- The phrase rendered "the fourth — the one fully held by a virtuous spiritual friend" refers to the standard fourfold classification in Prajñāpāramitā literature: the irreversible bodhisattva, the arhat, the skilled bodhisattva, and the bodhisattva who relies on a kalyāṇamitra. The fourth is genuinely the one sustained by a good spiritual friend rather than by inner realization alone.

The line "grasping even omniscience" in the learning section is deliberately paradoxical: the verse plays on the idea that even omniscience, if "grasped," is not truly grasped — this is the standard Prajñāpāramitā rhetorical inversion, and the apparent contradiction is intentional.

The term rendered "condition-awakened ones" in the list alongside "fruits" and "Protector of the World" refers to pratyekabuddhas, consistent with their mode of awakening through conditions without relying on a teacher's direct proclamation.

- The final verse is syntactically incomplete as transmitted here; the Tibetan breaks off mid-stanza without supplying an apodosis. The translation renders what is present and ends at the natural clause-break. This is a continuity issue in the source text rather than a translation uncertainty.

The simile of the king obtaining reverence through a support is an allusion to the reliquary-support motif: just as a king's presence sanctifies a place such that even his support-object receives honor in his absence, so the relics of the Buddha receive veneration because wisdom is their inner support. This is a standard doctrinal point in Perfection of Wisdom literature.

- The opening lines of this passage connect directly to the preceding stanza's final incomplete sentence about bodhicitta arising in the world; the translation accordingly flows from that point.

The phrase rendered "the unheated lake" refers to the mythological lake Anavatapta (Sanskrit), the source of the great rivers of Jambudvīpa, whose lord of nāgas sustains the waters. This is standard Indo-Tibetan cosmography.

The closing two lines are again incomplete, forming the protasis of a conditional whose apodosis presumably begins the next passage.

- The line "bodhisattvaḥ śrāvakaḥ bodhiṃ gacchati" is doctrinally dense: the bodhisattva on the path of skillful means does not attain the liberation of passing wholly beyond the three realms in the manner of a śrāvaka, yet does clear afflictions and manifests birth and death for the sake of beings. This tension is rendered as faithfully as the syntax allows.

The phrase "黒牛の境の森" literally means "forest at the boundary of a black cattle-herding area." This is a somewhat unusual geographical marker rendered contextually as "forest at the edge of a black cattle-herding district."

The passage ends mid-simile, consistent with the instruction that this is a continuation passage only.

- The phrase rendered "miraculous feet" translates the Tibetan for the four bases of miraculous power (rdzu 'phrul rkang pa, Skt. ṛddhipāda), a standard enumeration in Abhidharma literature; the literal "feet" is retained as it reflects the canonical term.

The line "moved by blessing" renders *byin gyis rabs kyis spyod*, where *byin gyis rabs* (Skt. *adhiṣṭhāna*) means the blessing or empowering grace of the buddhas; the sense is that the practitioner's activity is animated and sustained by that blessing rather than by ordinary conceptual volition.

- The final line is syntactically incomplete, breaking off mid-verse. The translation renders exactly what is present in the Tibetan without completing or guessing at the continuation. The verse is building toward an analogy involving old age and suffering, but the remainder is missing from the supplied passage.

The phrase rendered "the two grounds of the śrāvaka and the pratyekabuddha" refers to the levels attained by śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, which the Mahāyāna path surpasses — not literally two bodhisattva grounds.

- The passage about the bird leaping from the Heaven of the Thirty-Three presents a deliberate paradox: a being of enormous size but spent wings, illustrating that mere magnitude of form or effort does not guarantee safe arrival. The Tibetan "བློ་འཕྲོད་པ་ལྟར་འགྲོ་བཞིན་པ་" literally means "it will become a thing of harm and injury," rendered accordingly.

The phrase "མཉམ་པ་མེད་པ་" (does not lament, does not cry out) in the context of hearing the Perfection of Wisdom indicates absence of dismay or anguish upon encountering its profundity.

The line "མཉམ་པ་མེད་པ་ལྟར་འགྲོ་བཞིན་པ་" is somewhat compressed and could be read as "what has arisen free from qualities of difference between the awakening of the Sugatas" — the sense being that the suchness of awakening is undivided and qualitatively uniform across all buddhas. This reading is adopted above.

- The simile of the sesame oil and flame at the close of this passage is notably compressed and philosophically dense. The point being made is that awakening is neither produced by the first moment of a causal series alone nor by the last, just as sesame oil's essence is not burned by the first or last flame in isolation. This appears to be a Middle Way argument against both the first cause and the final cause being independently sufficient, with the full causal continuum being required. The passage breaks off mid-thought at the final line, consistent with the continuity framing of the prompt.

The phrase rendered "do not remain attached to those states of concentration" reflects the standard Mahāyāna caution that the bodhisattva enters the four dhyānas but transcends clinging to meditative absorption as an end in itself.

The phrase rendered "foremost among the herd" translates a term literally meaning "best of the herd" or "foremost bull," a traditional epithet suggesting excellence and leadership among practitioners.

- The image of the archer stringing arrows in midair so the first does not fall is a somewhat compressed simile. The meaning is that the bodhisattva, through continuous application of wisdom and skillful means, sustains the "flight" of practice indefinitely, deferring final entry into nirvāṇa until all roots of virtue are fulfilled. The phrase rendered "the two grounds" for མཉམ་པ་མེད་པ་ refers in context to the two extreme abodes to be transcended: saṃsāra and the private nirvāṇa of the śrāvakas, a standard Mahāyāna formulation.

- The phrase rendered "neither affirmed nor denied by scripture" translates lung ma bstan, which technically means "ethically neutral" or "indeterminate" in Abhidharma usage, but in this context the sense is that such conduct falls outside what can be straightforwardly categorized by scriptural statement — hence it is indeterminate or unspecified. The Abhidharma technical sense has been softened here to fit the context.

The section colophon "The fifth section teaches the full and perfect realization of the summit" refers to an internal chapter division of the source text, likely the Ratnaguṇasañcayagāthā or a related Perfection of Wisdom verse compilation, marking a structural division rather than a separate work.

- The phrase rendered "falls into the company of spirits" translates a construction meaning he "dwells mingled with" or "in the company of" pretas or supernatural beings, implying a degraded spiritual condition; the exact nuance of "spirit" here may carry a sense of pretas or of malevolent beings generally rather than specifically hungry ghosts.

The final stanza of this passage is syntactically incomplete in the source, ending mid-sentence with a relative clause. The translation preserves this open structure, indicating the passage

continues into the next section.

- The final line is syntactically incomplete in the source passage, breaking off mid-sentence at the standard illustrative analogy about the life-force faculty and the other faculties ceasing along with it. The translation renders what is present and trails off faithfully, as this is a mid-passage cut.

The phrase rendered "armor of merit is stripped away from the ground up" translates a Tibetan idiom meaning that accumulated merit accumulated from the very foundation is dismantled; the image of putting on armor for the bodhisattva path and having it torn off is a standard commentarial figure for losing merit through anger.

- The verse on the "holder of vidyā mantras" who causes unseasonable flowers to bloom is a condensed simile whose precise referent is slightly compressed in the Tibetan. The point appears to be: just as a master of vidyā mantras can cause flowers to bloom out of season and can bless through mantra-power while dwelling nowhere fixed, so too the skilled bodhisattva acts and blesses without fixed abode or object-clinging. This reading follows the natural flow of the surrounding context.

The phrase rendered "two kinds of wisdom" reflects a Tibetan construction that could refer to wisdom as a dual faculty or to the pair of wisdom and method; given the context of non-conceptuality and non-seeking, the meaning is that such a bodhisattva does not instrumentally pursue awakening through a dualistic wisdom-faculty.

- The final line ends mid-sentence in the source passage; the translation preserves this open ending faithfully, as the text continues beyond what was provided.

The phrase rendered "the self-arisen" translates rang byung thob par 'gyur, literally "will come to attain the self-arisen," a standard epithet for buddhahood or the naturally arisen state of awakening; some editions read this as attaining the "self-arisen" gnosis.

The line "free of marks" renders *mtshan ma med*, which carries the technical sense of signlessness, one of the three doors of liberation; the rendering preserves both the meditative and doctrinal resonance.

- The line rendered "like a vessel taking on water, all the qualities of buddhahood would be entirely lost" reads more literally as "like a boat that has been destroyed, all the qualities of the buddha are lost." The simile implies a vessel broken and sunk rather than merely leaking; either reading is defensible, but "vessel taking on water" from the preceding passage's context shapes the image here.

The phrase translated "the supreme awakening that leads beings onward" renders a compound in which the word for "guide" or "leader" modifies "awakening"; it may alternatively describe the bodhisattva as "a guide who swiftly attains supreme awakening." The translation adopted reads the syntax as an attributive construction qualifying awakening.

- The phrase rendered "ash of a spittle" (ㄆㄨˊ ㄕㄜˇ, "like the ash or dust of spittle") is an idiomatic expression of utter worthlessness; the final verse contrasts the joy of giving with the lesser joy of merely receiving, suggesting that the act of giving surpasses even the gain of the four continents.

The phrase "clear and pellucid" renders 明明白白 ("unobscured, pellucid, transparent"), which is a somewhat unusual term; the sense is that selflessness is directly and nakedly known, without obscuration.

- The text contains section headings interspersed in the verse, marking the sixth section as concluding a topic on giving, the seventh as teaching instantaneous full awakening, and the eighth as teaching the dharmakāya. These appear to be scribal or commentarial rubrics within the canonical transmission rather than verses themselves, and are rendered as prose intertitles

accordingly.

The phrase rendered "encircled by a precious wheel" refers to the image of a wheel-turning monarch, a cakravartin, used here as a simile for the awakened bodhisattva's sovereignty over the Dharma.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.